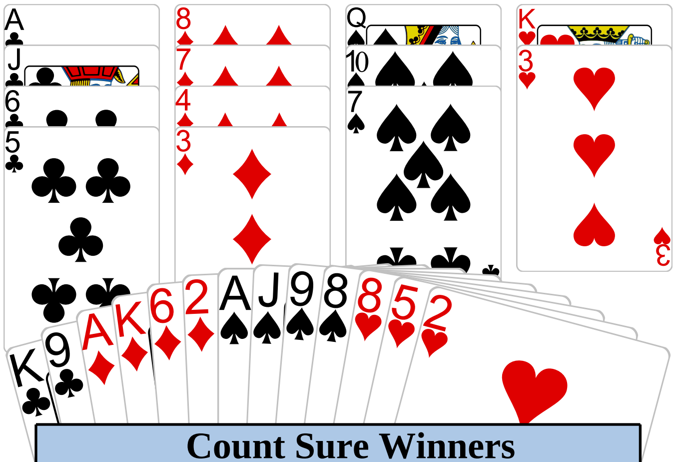
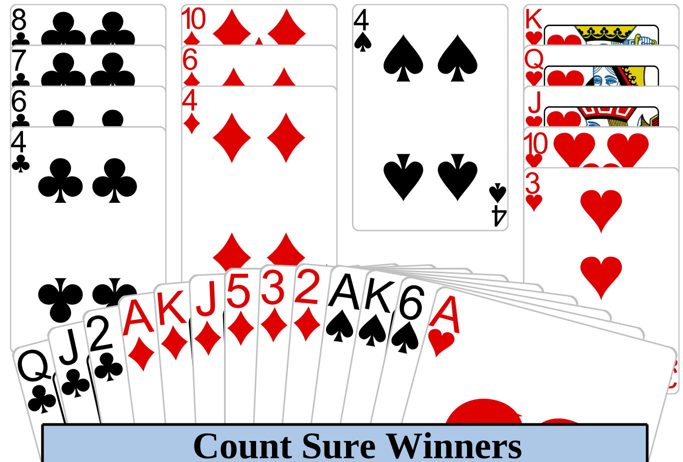
Deal 1 Ctr: **3NT** Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners			
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 3 Ctr: **3NT** Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners			
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A J 9 8 ♥ 8 5 2 ♦ A K 6 2 ♣ K 9	
♠ K 5 3 2 ♥ A Q J 10 ♦ J 10 ♣ 7 3 2	N W E S	♠ 6 4 ♥ 9 7 6 4 ♦ Q 9 5 ♣ Q 10 8 4
	♠ Q 10 7 ♥ K 3 ♦ 8 7 4 3 ♣ A J 6 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♣4, you play dummy's ♣5 and West plays the ♣7.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=3 Total = 6

You'd really like to find 3 winners without broaching that ♥ suit, so you decide to pin your hopes on the ♠ finesse. But you have a problem. When you win the first trick with the ♣9 your only safe entry to dummy is by leading your ♣K to the ♣A. And this uses up one of your ♣ winners! Do you see a way to avoid the problem?

Don't win the first trick with the ♣9, win with the ♣K. Then at trick two enter dummy by playing your ♣9 and finessing the ♣J! You are pretty sure East has led from the ♣Q so you expect this to work. Then play the ♠10, underplaying your ♠8. You had better cash the ♣A next, then the ♠Q, letting it ride if not covered. Finally, one last ♠ finesse gives you 4 ♠ winners.

This is another twist on the them of winning with a higher card than necessary.

Here it doesn't actually create an extra entry, it just preserves the one entry you have but saves you an actual trick.

Here is an interesting point. Suppose that East's opening lead had been a ♥ and West had taken the first four ♥ tricks then played a ♦. You would have played the hand the same way! Take the ♣K, then finesse the ♣J.

Board 3
East Deals
E-W Vul

	North	
	♠ 8 5 3 ♥ 8 6 5 2 ♦ Q 9 7 ♣ A 10 5	
♠ 4 ♥ K Q J 10 3 ♦ 10 6 4 ♣ 8 7 6 4	N W E S	♠ A K 6 ♥ A ♦ A K J 5 3 2 ♣ Q J 2
	♠ Q J 10 9 7 2 ♥ 9 7 4 ♦ 8 ♣ K 9 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	3♦	Pass
3♥	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by East

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠Q.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=0 Total = 5

There they are, four perfectly good ♥ tricks and no straightforward way to reach them. On the other hand, (I should say "In the other hand"), you have the possibility of 6 ♦ tricks, if the ♦Q drops, in which case you won't need the ♥ tricks at all. Can you work those two possibilities into a strategy?

Sure. The ♦ problem is that the outstanding ♦s may split 3-1 with one defender holding ♦ Q x x. So it would appear you could only get 5 ♦ winners. But you can thwart him like this.

Win the ♠. Unblock the ♥A. Now play the ♦J. If Mr. ♦ Q x x takes this trick dummy's ♦10 will become an entry to those wonderful ♥s. But if he cleverly refuses to win the ♦Q, then it will fall under your ♦ A K and you will get all 6 ♦ tricks.

The biggest problem with this great play is that North probably doesn't know for sure what you are doing to him.

Maybe after the hand is over he will appreciate it more and congratulate you.

Board 5 North Deals None Vul	♠ K ♥ A K 7 5 3 ♦ A K Q 6 ♣ K 10 5	
♠ 8 7 5 4 ♥ 10 8 ♦ J 9 7 2 ♣ Q 8 4	N W E S	♠ A 6 2 ♥ Q J 9 4 ♦ 10 3 ♣ 9 7 6 2
	♠ Q J 10 9 3 ♥ 6 2 ♦ 8 5 4 ♣ A J 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♥	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South